

PDF Merge Dashboard

User Guide

Educational PDF Generator · Simple Step-by-Step Guide

What Does This App Do?

PDF Merge Dashboard combines multiple PDF files into one complete document. It automatically adds a **class name header** on every page, **page numbers** in the footer, and a **table of contents** at the start — all driven by a simple Excel file you prepare.

What the final PDF contains:

Part	Description
Table of Contents	Lists every chapter and topic with page numbers
Merged Content	All your PDFs combined in Excel order
Header	Class / grade name printed on every page
Footer	Page number printed on every page

How to Launch the App

Double-click **PDF Merge Dashboard.exe**. The app opens maximised and is ready to use — no installation or internet connection required.

Step-by-Step Usage

Step 1 — Select Files

Fill in the three file paths at the top of the window:

① **Excel File (.xlsx)**

Your configuration file listing all PDFs in order. See the Excel Format section below.

② **Source PDFs Folder**

The folder on your computer that contains all the PDF files listed in the Excel.

③ **Output PDF Path**

Where the final combined PDF will be saved. Click Save As and type a filename.

■ Use the Browse buttons — you do not need to type the paths manually.

Step 2 — Preview & Adjust Header / Footer (Optional)

After selecting the source folder, click the purple **Preview** button.

A full-page view of your first PDF opens. You will see:

- Blue crosshair = Header position (class name)
- Red crosshair = Footer position (page number)

To move the header or footer, change the **X** and **Y** values in the left panel. The crosshairs update instantly on the page.

You can also change the **font**, **size** and **colour** for each element.

■ Click ✓ Close & Apply when you are happy. Your settings are saved.

Step 3 — Start the Merge

Click the green ■ **START MERGE** button.

The Process Log at the bottom shows each step in real time:

- Green lines = steps completed successfully
- Red lines = errors that stopped the process

When finished you will see:

■ Done! Final PDF → [your chosen path] Total pages: XX

■ The app also saves intermediate files in the same output folder for troubleshooting.

Excel File Format

Your Excel file (.xlsx) must have exactly these four column headings in the first row. Each row is one PDF file:

Column Name	What to Enter	Example
File_Name	Exact filename of the PDF (with .pdf extension)	chapter1.pdf
Chapter_Name	Chapter heading shown in the table of contents	Chapter 1
Topic_Name	Topic heading shown in the table of contents	Motion and Time
Class	Class or grade name — printed as header on pages	Class 8A

■ The column names are case-sensitive. File_Name must match the actual PDF filename exactly, including uppercase and lowercase letters.

Understanding X / Y Coordinates

The position of the header and footer is controlled by X and Y values. These follow the same system used inside PDF files:

Setting	Meaning
Origin (0, 0)	Bottom-LEFT corner of the page
X increases →	Moving right across the page (max 595 for A4)
Y increases ↑	Moving up the page (max 842 for A4)
Header default	X = 502, Y = 796 (top-right area)
Footer default	X = 528, Y = 37 (bottom-right area)

■ Use the Preview window to drag the crosshairs visually — you do not need to calculate coordinates manually.

Requirements & Limitations

Requirement	Detail
PDF page size	All PDFs must be A4 (210 × 297 mm). The app checks this automatically.
PDF filenames	Must match the File_Name column in Excel exactly (case-sensitive).
Excel format	Must be .xlsx format with the four required columns.
Output folder	Must exist on your computer and be writable.
Microsoft Word	Not required — the table of contents is generated internally.

Troubleshooting

Error / Problem	What to Do
Non-A4 pages found	Open the listed PDFs in any PDF editor and resize/export them as A4.
File missing error	Check that the filename in the Excel File_Name column matches the actual PDF filename exactly.
Header or footer not visible	If you set the colour to white, text is invisible on a white page. Change the colour.
Preview shows no PDF	Select a Source PDFs Folder first — the preview uses the first PDF it finds there.
Process log is empty	Click Start Merge — the log only fills when a merge is running.
App does not open	Run the .exe directly from your local drive, not from a network or USB drive.

Output Files Explained

After a successful merge, the output folder contains:

File	What it is
final_combined.pdf	Your final document — this is the one to use
final_index.pdf	The table of contents page only
merged_with_header.pdf	All PDFs merged with header and footer added
merged_content.pdf	All PDFs merged (no header/footer yet)

■ The intermediate files are kept so you can inspect each stage if something looks wrong.